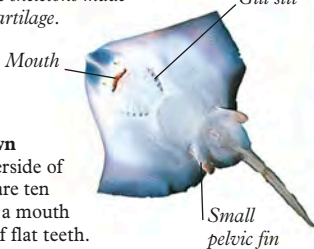


These sharp spines protect the ray. Stingrays also have one very large poisonous spine which they use to stab their enemies.



e skeletons made of cartilage. Gill slit



On the underside of a ray, there are ten gill slits and a mouth that is full of flat teeth.

Most rays are less than 6.5 feet (two meters) wide, but a manta ray can grow to more than 30 feet (nine meters) in width. Luckily for divers, it only eats plankton and small fish.



When a ray is lying on the sea bottom, its mouth is blocked, so it sucks in water through a tiny hole, called a spiracle, behind each eye.



*By flapping their fins, rays /
disturb the sand and uncover
crabs—a tasty snack for a ray.*

A ray is one of the most graceful swimmers in the sea. Flapping its broad fins, it “flies” like an underwater bird.

